AI NEWS DIGEST

Monday, 26 October 2026

40 articles scanned | 8 sources | top 6 stories summarised by AI

TODAY IN AI

- OpenAI and Anthropic slashed LLM prices dramatically, citing lower cache costs and competitive pressure; pricing cuts affect developer budgets and market dynamics.
- Researchers explore optimal distillation strategies for LLM agents, questioning onpolicy vs offpolicy training levels.
- A new framework proposes tooldriven agentic synthesis for RF and mmWave hardware design, highlighting automation potential.

TOP STORIES

1. OpenAI and Anthropic cut their LLM prices by up to 80% within a few months. Why?

Hacker News | Business | importance 8/10 | 25 Oct

OpenAI and Anthropic reduced LLM prices up to 80% by cutting cache read costs and introducing cheaper model tiers, lowering operational expenses for developers and intensifying price competition.

2. Beyond On-Policy vs. Off-Policy: At What Level Should LLM Agent Distillation Follow the Student?

arXiv cs.AI | Research | importance 7/10 | 26 Oct

A paper investigates whether LLM agent distillation should follow onpolicy or offpolicy methods, aiming to improve student model efficiency and alignment.

3. TACS-RF: Tool-driven Agentic Circuit Synthesis of RF and mmWave Modules

arXiv cs.AI | Tools | importance 7/10 | 26 Oct

Researchers present TACSRF, a tooldriven agentic system that automates synthesis of RF and mmWave modules, demonstrating AI's role in hardware design.

4. Google's AI search changes upended online publishing

The Verge AI | Tools | importance 7/10 | 25 Oct

Google's AI Overviews place AIgenerated summaries atop search results, diverting clicks from original publishers and threatening their traffic and revenue.

5. AI use leads UC Berkeley math professor to see 'no point' in grading homework

Hacker News | Business | importance 6/10 | 25 Oct

UC Berkeley Fields Medalist stops grading homework after students consistently use AI to achieve top scores, questioning the relevance of traditional assessment.

6. What the US Movement Against Data Centers Can Learn From Abroad

Wired AI | Tools | importance 6/10 | 25 Oct

Paris Marx's book traces worldwide opposition to datacenter growth, linking environmental impacts to political movements and warning of AIdriven demand.

ALSO WORTH KNOWING

Research

- Permission to Retry: A Study of Authorization and Recovery in AI Agent Workflows (arXiv cs.AI)
- Don't Forget What You Just Learned: Self-Directed Repair Turns Agent Mistakes Into Lasting Lessons (arXiv cs.AI)

Tools

- PaperFormalizer: Author-in-the-Loop Autoformalization of Research Papers in Lean (arXiv cs.AI)
- Oai-math-revised: a community hub for revising OpenAI's math write-ups (Hacker News)
- Here are the top AI agents that can live in your text messages (TechCrunch AI)
- Orchestrating SageMaker AI endpoint auto scaling with AWS CDK (AWS ML Blog)

Business

- No signs of AI payoff outside the tech sector (Hacker News)

Policy

- AI didn't cause the tech jobs bust, but it explains why there's no recovery (Hacker News)
- r/opensource just banned AI, non-English speakers, and more (The Verge AI)
- Intel gets waiver after worries fuzzy US ban on foreign-made robots may hit fabs (Ars Technica AI)

Sources: Hugging Face, AWS ML Blog, TechCrunch AI, The Verge AI, Ars Technica AI, Wired AI, arXiv cs.AI, Hacker News.
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